



Fig. 7: (a) Nokia N90, (b) Nokia N95 and (c) Nokia 808 PureView



Fig. 8: The first collaboration between Sony and Zeiss, Sony Handycam CCD-TR555

Yashica, Sony, Logitech and Alpha. It either provided its brand for co-branding of lenses that were developed by other companies, or licensed its technology to them for complete optical design and manufacturing.

Zeiss and Nokia.

Zeiss entered the cell-phone camera market with Nokia, which had,

by 2004, become the world's most sold cellphone brand. And yet, Nokia did not have the best phone camera. Sony Ericsson did. So Nokia roped in Zeiss to develop a lens for its cellphone. The result was N90, which was launched in April 2005 with 2MP camera by Zeiss.

The partnership produced a series of phones and had a steady hold over the consumer market, including Nokia N95 with 5MP camera.

The milestone of Nokia and Zeiss partnership was the launch of Nokia 808 PureView in 2012. The highlight was the name of the phone, which was solely based on the imaging quality of the phone camera.

What brought Nokia down was the launch of Apple's iPhone and the multitude of Android phones. Both were software that were far superior to Nokia's Symbian. Even Microsoft buyout did not help, because the launches post this were using the not-so-popular-for-cellphones Windows platform.

Recently, Nokia made an attempt to come back on Android platform—Nokia 8—again with Zeiss lens. At last count, early this year, it had managed to gather a little over one per cent of the global cellphone market. While this is a far cry from its earlier high, it is not a total dud!

Nokia recently launched Nokia 6.1 and 5.1. And while Apple and Android are far ahead, we will have to wait and watch to see if this attempted comeback by Nokia goes anywhere.

Zeiss and Sony. Well before the Nokia partnership, there was the Zeiss-Sony one, which commenced in 1995. It is another great example of ingredient branding. Because here too, just like Nokia, Sony was not well-known for optics and photography. However, since Sony was a reputable name with consumers, it used the expertise of Zeiss to launch a range of camcorders and digital cameras.

The first product launch of this partnership was Sony Handycam CCD-TR555. The partnership has also launched

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